



IN PURSUIT OF TRUTH

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11 banks faces TK 221,1233cr capital deficit



Sakib seek first Ashes on England



Russia hits industrial facilities in Ukraine

State budget includes state employee pay raises

MAHAFUZAR RAHAMAN

We are facing many challenges. As a result of the shortage of foreign exchange reserves and electricity, gas, etc., the life of common people has become miserable, a deadlock-like situation has electricity, gas, etc., the life of common people has become miserable, a deadlock-like situation has been created in trade and commerce. The unemployment rate is gradually increasing and the overall economic condition is deteriorating. Finance Minister AHM Mustafa Kamal presented a budget of Tk 7.61 trillion for the fiscal year 2023-24, setting a target of achieving 7.5 per cent GDP growth while keeping the average inflation at 6.0 per cent. An accident is occurred and bla bla bla, which is called the very fundamental of journalism. The proposed expenditure is 15.33 per cent more than the revised budget of the outgoing fiscal year. That volume is equal to 15.21 per cent of the total GDP of Bangladesh. The deficit between income and expenditure in the budget remains a record which is 5.2 per cent of GDP. The government wants to get a loan of Tk 1.02 trillion (1 lakh two thousand 490 crores). The rest of the gap will be met with internal financing. While giving the budget for the current fiscal year (2022-23), the global situation and the domestic shocks cited were to be there. Yet we assumed the GDP growth rate and inflation at 7.5 per cent and 5.4 per cent respectively. We assumed that our foreign exchange reserves of US\$ 46 billion and exchange rate would not change. But the assumptions in the budget did not match the reality. This happens when budgeting is done based on desire rather than reality. It combines of several tasks like government steps and citizens consciousness as well as the policy making system of Bangladesh. For the welfare of this we have to work hard in a way.

Annual Budget Table Marketing Expenses

10 Rows, Expandable, 5 Columns, Category Icons, Cost, Budget, Actual, Balance, Cumulative

Cost Description	Budget	Actual	Balance	Cumulative
Creatives	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX
HR Team	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX
SEO	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX
PR	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX
Content Marketing	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX
Tools	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX
Infrastructure	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX
Website	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX
Total	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX	\$ X XXX

The GDP growth is expected to rebound to 6.7 percent in 2021-22, Fitch Ratings said. Segregation of the Budget FY21-22. Source: Ministry of Finance, GoB The Photo: Reuters

The proposed 2023-2024 fiscal year budget in terms of inflation, GDP, etc. is not very similar to the reality. The goals are quite ambitious which may not be achieved due to weaknesses in assumptions. International credit rating agency Moody's downgrading the credit rating of Bangladesh sparked the fear that foreign investment in the private sector would decrease. This will not only reduce private investment, but also will have a major negative impact on import-export trade. Analysts fear that the supply of foreign currency will further decrease as per Moody's rating.

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SEE PAGE 2 COL 2



Don't print new money, Dr Wahiduddin Mahmud advises BB

Prominent economist Dr Wahiduddin Mahmud has advised the Bangladesh Bank not to lend to the state by printing new money to curb the growing inflation. He made the suggestions on Thursday while Governor Abdur Rouf Talukder discussed with Dr Wahiduddin to find a way of controlling growing inflation and fluctuation of price of US dollar. Wahiduddin suggested a proper implementation of the current monetary policy and not to loan money to the government by printing new money. Executive Director and spokesperson of BB, Md Mezbauul Hoque, told reporters. The spokesman said that the governor will talk with other senior and experienced economists on the economic situation of the country. 'Controlling inflation is a very important issue to resolve the country's economic crisis. So, we have decided to discuss with experts from different sectors of the economy. SEE PAGE 2 COL 2

Kamal seeks expert opinions on why remittances fall despite rising manpower export



The Finance Minister AHM Mustafa Kamal on Monday sought innovative suggestions from economists and sector experts to identify the reasons why inward remittance flow is not growing to the expected level, despite huge manpower export and students who stay back and work abroad. He said that the government will accept suggestions and advice to reform policy and increase desired remittance into the country. Kamal said this while speaking as the chief guest in the inaugural session of 'Bangladesh's Public Financial Reforms Initiatives' in collaboration with the World Bank held in a hotel in Dhaka on Monday. SEE PAGE 2 COL 2

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Delay hilsa ban by a month

STAFF CORRESPONDENT

Hilsa traders in Barishal yesterday demanded that the government implement restrictions on catching hilsa from November 12 instead of the existing planned date of October 12. They demanded this at a press conference held by the Sadar Thana unit of 'Barishal Matsya Malik Samitee' at the 'Elish Bhaban' office of the city's Port Road wholesale Hilsa market. Secretary of Barisal Sadar Thana Matso Arotard Association, Nirob Hossen Tutul, said in a statement that various natural factors, including climate change, have negatively affected hilsa production, leading to a lower supply this year than in the previous ten years. Hilsa traders in Barishal yesterday demanded that the government implement restrictions on catching hilsa from November 12 instead of the existing planned date of October 12. Hilsa traders in Barishal yesterday demanded that the government implement restrictions on catching hilsa from November 12 instead of the existing planned date of October 12. Hilsa traders in Barishal yesterday demanded that the government implement restrictions on catching hilsa from November 12 instead of the existing planned date of October 12. SEE PAGE 2 COL 2

Chattogram bay terminal: Final master plan likely this month

STAFF CORRESPONDENT

The groundbreaking work of the Bay terminal of Chattogram seaport is likely in October subject to the approval of the proposed construction master plan this month. Chattogram Port Authority (CPA) chairman Rear Admiral Mohammad Sohail said, 'The master plan is now in its final stages. It'll be done within this month.' The master plan has been framed by two consultants - Kun Hwa Engineering and Consulting Company Ltd and Daeyoung Engineering Company Ltd of South Korea. According to sources, the master plan is likely to get the go-ahead within this month (September) as the draft is now in its final stage. Therefore, the groundbreaking work of the terminal is expected in the next month (October).

Chattogram Port Authority (CPA) chairman Rear Admiral Mohammad Sohail said, 'The master plan is now in its final stages. It'll be done within this month.' He said, 'After completing the final master plan, Ground Breaking Work for "Bay Terminal" is likely to be started in October in the current year.'

The development project proposal (DPP) for the terminal construction would also be approved next month, he hoped.

Bay terminal is being set up on 900 acres of land along Patenga coastline with all modern port facilities to mobilise port activities and reduce transport costs.

The two Korean companies were appointed as consultants for the terminal project in April 2022.

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Japan to compile economic package to ease inflation pain

REUTERS

Japan's Prime Minister Fumio Kishida unveiled on Monday the pillars of a new economic stimulus package to be compiled next month to help households ease the pain of price hikes and boost wages.

Kishida will instruct his cabinet on Tuesday to put together the package and swiftly set up an extra budget to fund it, he said. It will include measures to protect people from cost-push inflation, back sustainable wage and income growth, promote domestic investment to spur growth, reform to overcome dwindling populations, and encourage infrastructure investment.



With the new economic measures, the premier pledged to shift Japan's economy, which has tended to focus on cost cutting, away from such practices. Kishida also warned investors trying to sell off the yen, which will boost import bills for food and energy, saying he was closely watching currency moves with a high sense of urgency.

'It's important for currencies to move stably reflecting fundamentals,' Kishida said in his rare remarks on the foreign exchange market. 'Excessive volatility is undesirable.'

The size and substance of the extra budget remains unclear. When asked about the chance of dissolving parliament's lower house to call a snap election, Kishida said he was not thinking about such an option as he must now focus on the new stimulus and other issues that cannot wait.

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Mourning

With profound grief we inform of the sad demise of our friend Howard Ong.

Howard Ong

DANGUE CASES AND DEATHS		
Figure until September 27		
Dhaka	110,889	690
Chattogram	28,9086	80
Khulna	12,876	17
Sylhet	5,654	33
Rangpur	11,765	98
Cumilla	21332	41

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